

Mozilla's Firefox Mobile OS vs Apple iOS, Android and Windows 8

The fiercely competitive smartphone market has witnessed the entry of yet another mobile OS. The Firefox OS from Mozilla does come with a few technology advantages, but it may take more than that to unseat the well-established Android and Apple phones from their positions of dominance in this market. Nevertheless, the battle has begun...

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The war for dominance in the smartphone and tablet domain will now escalate, with Firefox (the popular Web browser from Mozilla) launching its own Linux-

Web standards and devices, independence from any one single vendor, and clear interest in emerging markets is a smart way to debut.

On February 24, 2013, just prior to the Mobile World Congress 2013, the Mozilla Foundation announced



Fig. 1: Snapshots of Firefox OS

based operating system (OS) for these devices. According to sources, this will truly challenge Apple's iOS, Google's Android and Microsoft's Windows 8—currently the biggest players among mobile phone OSs. An alternative OS could bring in some fresh air into the market. For developers, Mozilla had launched its Firefox Simulator last year with versions 1.0 and 2.0, and has just launched version 3.0.

But the big question is, "Why switch to Firefox OS?" Would it make business sense?

Mozilla may be a late arrival at the mobile OS party, but its focus on open

the commercial launch of its preview Firefox OS for mobile devices, with 17 mobile operators and four OEMs. However, that attack on Apple and Android was nothing more than a good student project in building an operating system.

Technical considerations of Firefox OS

"Firefox OS is like Chrome OS, which runs a Web browser on top of Linux."

Firefox OS is designed to allow HTML5/CSS applications to communicate directly with the device's hardware using JavaScript. However,



Fig. 2: Editing images



Fig. 3: Support for HTML5

HTML5 is having some performance issues on low-cost mobiles. According to sources, Firefox OS could make cheaper smartphones possible. It is aimed at users who want to use a phone for only text messaging and to make calls, which means low-cost or low-end mobile devices. But the market is already full of cheap Android